



compete with incumbents. Transformative innovation is about problem transformation, which changes the game and makes disruptive innovation almost irrelevant.

The point

When my son and I were playing, we intended to entertain ourselves. When he realised that he was being outsmarted, he transformed his problem. He changed the game and levelled the playing field by staying focused on our intent.

You can also transform and change the game, but only if you think two steps ahead of disruptors. If you want to do that, you must shift your focus from customers' problems to customers' intents. When you respond to those intents in the best way you can, you will stay ahead of the curve!

So, how do you embrace transformative innovation? Well, that is the topic for our next few articles. But here are some pre-requisites. You need to acknowledge these distinctions and accept that you are going to need incremental and efficiency innovation.

However, most organisations are not designed for the third type of innovation, that is, disruptive innovation. So, when they attempt doing that, they look like a dad dancing at a teenager's party.

Leave disruptive innovation to the startups. Instead, you change the game while they are busy changing the business model. **END** 🐧

This level of innovation, in my view, is transformative, and hence it is apt to call it 'Transformative Innovation!'

Businesses must progress beyond business transformation and start thinking about problem transformation.

Are you still trying to make a better hammer or have started making a drill machine? Perhaps you should, instead, start focusing on how you can help your customers make a hole in the wall.

But think again: Did you want to help your customers display beautiful pictures on their walls? Depending on how you see it, what you do will change significantly.

After all, why would someone make a hole in the wall when they can use removable stickers?

People who used taxis before shifted to Uber *et al* for their urban commute, which significantly covered (about 65%) office going population. However, when this working population starts to work from anywhere, they will not need to use taxis much. Instead, they will use Zoom, Skype, or MS-Teams, eliminating or reducing the need for taxis significantly.

YOU CAN TRANSFORM AND CHANGE THE GAME IF YOU SHIFT YOUR FOCUS FROM CUSTOMERS' PROBLEMS TO CUSTOMERS' INTENTS.

This change will morph the competitive landscape, and you will find Uber and others competing for the customer's wallet share with Zoom and others.

Disruptive innovation was a solution to supersede incremental innovation and

By: Anand Tamboli

The author is a serial entrepreneur, speaker, award-winning author, and an emerging technology thought leader.

The article was originally published in the April 2021 issue of Electronics For You.